

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ J 10 6 2
♦ K J 9 5 4 2
♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 6

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5
♥ 9 7 3
♦ A 8 7
♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A 10 6
♥ A K Q 4
♦ Q 10 3
♣ Q J 2

West	North	East	South
	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♣ A			

[showcards W:DA N:D3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.
Partner led the ♣ A. Seeing your ♣ 3 he next played
the ♦ A. What will you play on this trick?

Play the ♦ 2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦ 9 to
encourage East to play a second ♦ through dummy's
♦ Q 10.

But this time you really want him to take his ♣ K. So
play the discouraging ♦ 2 and hope he gets the
message to go back to ♣ s. If he does play the ♣ K
next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5
♥ K Q 8 5 3
♦ 9 6 2
♣ J 4

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ K 7 3



♠ J 10 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ A 9 5

♠ A K Q

♥ A 10

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8 6 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

[showcards S:CQ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, South won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. South then put the ♣Q on the table.

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like South is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners? That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ West played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s, obviously 3. And South must also have a third one,

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2

♥ J 10 3

♦ A K 10

♣ J 10 3



♠ 7 5

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ Q J 3

♣ A K 9

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North

Lead: ♠5
number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that North has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to East's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

[showcards W:S5]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. North liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by North's ♠Q. North pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and East plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick North drops the ♥J and East the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe North is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe North when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that North has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

Board 4

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 10
♥ 9 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ A K 10 6 3

♠ 6 4

♥ A J 8

♦ A Q J 6

♣ 8 7 5 4



♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 7 6 4 3

♦ K 10

♣ J 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♣ A			

[showcards W:CA E:C2 S:C9 N:C4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣ A, East played the ♣ 2 and South the ♣ 9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣ 6.

On first thought East's ♣ 2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣ Q and ♣ J. If East started with ♣ J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ J. If East started with ♣ Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣ 2 or with ♣ Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣ Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣ Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.